

Dr Halle Quang

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Executive Summary

I completed my doctoral research training in Neuropsychology at the University of New South Wales, where I investigated apathy in Vietnamese patients with traumatic brain injury. My current research extends to examining dementia-related cognitive and behavioural changes in low and middle-income countries and culturally diverse populations. By employing clinical and neuroimaging methods, I explore the complex interplay between neurobiological and socio-cultural factors underlying disease-specific syndromes, ultimately offering insights for designing culturally appropriate interventions.

Education And Qualifications

2019-2023 **PhD (Neuropsychology)**, University of New South Wales, Australia.
2018 **MSc (Brain and Mind Sciences)**, The University of Sydney, Australia.
2010-2014 **BSc + Hons (Psychology and Education)**, Ho Chi Minh City University of Education, Vietnam (First Class Honours and University Medal)

Academic Appointments

Postdoctoral Research Fellow (full-time) – July 2023 – now
Frontotemporal Dementia Group, School of Psychology and Brain and Mind Centre, University of Sydney, Australia.
Research Officer (full-time) – June 2021 – July 2023
Frontotemporal Dementia Group, School of Psychology and Brain and Mind Centre, University of Sydney, Australia.
Research Assistant (part-time) – Jan 2012 – Nov 2015
School of Psychology, Ho Chi Minh City University of Education, Vietnam.

Awards

- **Best poster** – EMCR/Staff Category, Forefront Scientific Meeting, 2022.
- **PhD Research Award**, International Neuropsychological Society, 2021 (5 recipients worldwide).
- **University Medal**, Ho Chi Minh City University of Education, Vietnam, 2014.
- **Author prize at the National festival for Student Research**, Ministry of Education and Training, Vietnam, 2013.
- **Young Research Talents Award**, Ministry of Education and Training, Vietnam, 2012.
- **Euréka Scientific Research Award for Students**, Ho Chi Minh City Youth Union, Vietnam, 2012.

Research grants and Fellowships

- Travel Grant – **International Brain Research Organisation** to attend to the **International Neuropsychological Society Conference** in San Diego - USA, 2023

- Travel Grant – **International Society of Frontotemporal Dementia Paris-Lille Congress, 2022**
- **Sydney Vietnam Institute and Sydney Southeast Asia Centre Seed Funding Grant, 2022** for a research project “*Characterising behavioural and psychological symptoms in Vietnamese older adults: Insights for culturally appropriate research and clinical practice*”.
- **Australian Graduate Women Hale Barbara Fellowship, 2021** (2 recipients nationwide) for a research project “*Investigating clinical profiles and neurobiological mechanisms of apathy, empathy and depression in dementia*”.
- **UNSW Scientia PhD and Australian Government Research Training Program Scholarship, 2019 - 2023.**
- **Scholarship for Outstanding Students, Ho Chi Minh City University of Education, Vietnam, 2010-2014.**
- **Lawrence S. Tings Scholarship for Excellent Students, Lawrence S. Tings Foundation, Vietnam, 2013 - 2014.**

Publications	
Journal Articles/Book Chapter	
2025	Li, R., Quang, H. , Filipčiková, M., Xu, Y., Kumfor, F., Spehar, B., & McDonald, S. (2025). Why Do Cultures Affect Facial Emotion Perception? A Systematic Review. <i>Journal of Cross-Cultural Psychology</i> , https://doi.org/10.1177/002202212513348
2025	Mai, L., Quang, H. , Nguyen-Martinez, A., & Nguyen, M. (2025). Assessment of Adults and Older Adults. In <i>How to Support the Neuropsychological Health of the Vietnamese Diaspora</i> (pp. 66-86). Routledge.
2025	Quang, H. , Hellerslia, V., Graves, L., & Thieu, Y. (2025). Health-Related Beliefs, Values, and Attitudes. In <i>How to Support the Neuropsychological Health of the Vietnamese Diaspora</i> (pp. 21-33). Routledge.
2025	Quang, H. , Nguyen-Martinez, A., Nghia, H. T. T., & Mai, L. (2025). The Comprehensive Neuropsychological Interview: Navigating Questions, Interpreters, Collateral Information. In <i>How to Support the Neuropsychological Health of the Vietnamese Diaspora</i> (pp. 37-48). Routledge.
2024	Nguyen-Martinez, A. L., Pham, N., Ba, C., Veeramuthu, V., & Quang, H. (2024). Pediatric neuropsychological assessment in Southeast Asia: Current status and future directions with Vietnam as a scoping review case example. <i>Archives of Clinical Neuropsychology</i> . https://doi.org/10.1093/arclin/acae106
2024	Quang, H. , Wearne T., Filipcikova, M., Pham, N., Nguyen, N. & McDonald S. (2024). A biopsychosocial framework for apathy following moderate to severe traumatic brain injury: A systematic review and systematic review. <i>Neuropsychology Review</i> . 34(4), 1213-1234.
2023	Nguyen, M.-N., Pham, R., Nguyen, TV., Lam-Nguyen, NT., McDonald, S. & Quang, H. (2023). Neuropsychiatric Symptoms after Moderate to Severe Traumatic Brain Injury in

	Vietnam: Assessment, Prevalence and Impact on Caregivers. <i>Journal of International Neuropsychological Society</i> , 29(10), 984-993.
2023	Quang, H. , Le Heron, C., Balleine, B., Nguyen, T-V., Nguyen, T-Q., Nguyen, M.N., Kumfor, F., & McDonald, S. (2023). Reduced Sensitivity to Background Reward Underlying Motivational Disorders: Insight from Apathy after Traumatic Brain Injury. <i>Neuroscience</i> , 528, 26-36.
2023	Quang, H. , Nguyen, A., Do, C, McDonald, S. & Nguyen, C (2023). Examining the Montreal Cognitive Assessment among healthy Vietnamese adults and patients with traumatic brain injury <i>The Clinical Neuropsychologist. Special Issue on Asian Neuropsychology</i> , 37(5), 1062-1077
2023	Nguyen, T-Q., Hoang, C. B. D., Hoang Le, M. D., Anh Vo, N. T., Quang, H. , Nguyen, C. M., Goodman, C., Savva, G., Pham, VL., Tran, TT., Vo, V.T. & Ha, T.T.H (2023). Examining the Montreal Cognitive Assessment-Basic (MoCA-B) and Informant Questionnaire on Cognitive Decline in the Elderly (IQCODE) among elderly Vietnamese. <i>The Clinical Neuropsychologist. Special Issue on Asian Neuropsychology</i> , 37(5), 1043-1061
2023	Filipcikova, M., Quang, H. , Cassel, A., Darke, L., Wilson, E., Wearne, T., Rosenberg, H. & McDonald, S. (2023). Exploring neuropsychological underpinnings of poor communication after traumatic brain injury: The role pf apathy, disinhibition and social cognition. <i>International Journal of Language & Communication Disorders</i> . Accepted on 2022 Dec 21.
2022	Quang, H. , Kumfor, F., Balleine, B., Nguyen, T. V., Nguyen, T. Q., Nguyen, M. N., & McDonald, S. (2022). Contributions of intrinsic and extrinsic reward sensitivity to apathy: Evidence from traumatic brain injury. <i>Neuropsychology</i> , 36(8), 791–802.
2022	Quang, H. , McDonald, S., Huynh-Le, P., Nguyen, T. V., Le, N. A., Lam-Nguyen, N. T., & Kumfor, F. (2022). Apathy in a high prevalence population of moderate to severe traumatic brain injury: An investigation in Vietnam. <i>Neuropsychology</i> , 36(1), 94-102.
2022	Quang, H. , Sin, K. & McDonald, S. (2022). Adaptation, validation and preliminary standardisation of the Frontal Systems Behaviour Scale – Apathy Subscale and the Dimensional Apathy Scale in Vietnamese healthy samples. <i>Journal of the International Neuropsychological Society</i> , 20(3), 300-310.
2021	Quang, H. , Wong, S., Husain, M., Piguet, O., Hodges, J. R., Irish, M., & Kumfor, F. (2021). Beyond language impairment: Profiles of apathy in primary progressive aphasia. <i>Cortex</i> , 139, 73-85.
2015	Nguyen, T. & Quang, H. (2015). Factors related to retirement crisis in the elderly living in Ho Chi Minh City. <i>Journal of Science - Special Issue: Social Sciences and Humanities</i> , 10(76), 145-150.
2015	Quang, H. & Nguyen, M. C. (2015). Investigating sex knowledge of the blind from 12 to 18 years old at Nguyen Dinh Chieu school for the blind, Ho Chi Minh City. <i>Journal of Science - Special Issue: Educational Studies</i> , 8(74), 110-119.

2014	Huynh, S., Mai, H. & Quang, H. (2014). Alcoholism among young adults in Ho Chi Minh City. <i>Journal of Science - Special Issue: Social Sciences and Humanities</i> 55(89). 173-183.
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Published Abstracts	
2023	Quang, H. , Mencevski, F., Piguet, O., Husain, M., Landin-Romero, R., & Kumfor, F. (2023). Apathy, empathy and depression in Alzheimer's disease and frontotemporal dementia: Examining the constructs and white matter correlates. <i>Alzheimer's & Dementia</i> , 19, e077102.
2023	Landin-Romero, R., Quang, H. , Matis, S., D'Souza, A., Calamante, F., & Piguet, O. (2023). Trajectories of white matter degeneration in frontotemporal dementia: new insights using fixel-based analysis. <i>Alzheimer's & Dementia</i> , 19, e075909.
2023	Quang, H. , Nguyen, A., Do, C., McDonald, S., & Nguyen, C. (2023). The Vietnamese Montreal Cognitive Assessment: An Evaluation of Construct Validity and Recommended Cut-off for Cognitive Impairment after TBI. <i>Journal of the International Neuropsychological Society</i> , 29(s1), 592-593.
2022	Marian, O. C., Teo, J. D., Quang, H. , Lee, J. Y., Kwok, J. B., Halliday, G., ... & Don, A. S. (2022). Frontotemporal dementia caused by progranulin mutations is characterised by disrupted myelin lipid metabolism. <i>Journal Of Neurochemistry</i> , 162, 46.
2021	Quang, H. , Kumfor, F., Nguyen, T.V., Nguyen, T.Q, Nguyen, M.N, Balleine, B. & McDonald, S. (2021). Altered intrinsic and extrinsic reward sensitivity underpins apathy: Evidence from moderate-to-severe traumatic brain injury. <i>Journal of the Neurological Sciences</i> , 429, 119231.

International Conference Oral Presentations	
Year	Details
Talks at International conferences	
2024	Nguyen-Martinez, A., Ba, C., Pham, N. & Quang, H. (2024). Current State and Future Directions for Pediatric Neuropsychological Evaluations with Vietnamese Children: A PRISMA Review. <i>52nd INS NYC Annual North American Meeting</i> , New York, United States
2024	Veeramuthu, V., Ammaippan, P., Sakamoto, M., Quang, H. , Sundaram-Patel, S., Choi, E., Yu-Ling, C., Chi-Cheng, Y., Hom, C., Wen-Yu, C., and Fuji, D., on behalf of the ANA International Liaison Taskforce. (2024). Clinical Neuropsychology in Asia: Variability in Training Models, Barriers and the Need for Standardization of Training Guideline. <i>52nd INS NYC Annual North American Meeting</i> , New York, United States
2023	McDonald, S., Filipcikova, M. Quang, H. , et al. (2023). Is there a relationship between emotion dysregulation and social cognition following Traumatic Brain Injury? <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . Taiwan.
2023	Landin-Romero, R., Quang, H. , et al. (2023). Trajectories of white and grey matter degeneration in frontotemporal dementia. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . Taiwan.
2023	On, N., ... Quang, H. (2023). Effort Exertion as an Intrinsic Reward: A Cross-Cultural Investigation in Vietnam and Australia. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . Taiwan.
2023	Quang, H. et al. (2023). Apathy, empathy and depression in Alzheimer's disease and frontotemporal dementia: Examining the constructs and white matter correlates. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . Taiwan.

2023	Quang, H. , Nguyen, A., Do, C., McDonald, S. & Nguyen, C. (2023). The Vietnamese Montreal Cognitive Assessment: An Evaluation of Construct Validity and Recommended Cut-off for Cognitive Impairment after TBI. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . San Diego - USA.
2023	Li, R., Filipčíková, M., Xu, Y., Quang, H. , Kumfor, F. & McDonald, S. (2023). Why Do Cultures Affect Facial Emotion Perception? – A Systematic Review. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . San Diego - USA.
2022	Quang, H. et al. (2022). Apathy, empathy and depression in behavioural frontotemporal dementia and Alzheimer's disease: Are we talking about the same thing? <i>International Society of Frontotemporal Dementia Biennial Congress</i> . Paris – Lille, France.
2022	Marian, O. C., Teo, J. D., Quang, H. , Lee, J. Y., Kwok, J. B., Halliday, G., ... & Don, A. S. (2022). Frontotemporal dementia caused by progranulin mutations is characterised by disrupted myelin lipid metabolism. <i>International Society for Neurochemistry Conference</i> , Hawaii, USA.
2022	Quang, H. et al. (2022). Apathy in a high prevalence population of moderate to severe traumatic brain injury: An investigation in Vietnam. <i>Southeast Asia Mental Health Conference</i> . Online
2022	Quang, H. et al. (2022). Contributions of Foreground and Background Reward Sensitivity to Apathy after Traumatic Brain Injury. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . Barcelona - Spain.
2022	Quang, H. et al. (2022). Examining Apathy in Vietnam – a Country with High Prevalence of Moderate to Severe Traumatic Brain Injury. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . New Orleans – USA (virtual).
2021	Quang, H. et al. (2021). Altered intrinsic and extrinsic reward sensitivity underpins apathy: Evidence from moderate-to-severe traumatic brain injury. <i>World Congress of Neurology</i> . Rome – Italy (virtual).
2021	Quang, H. et al. (2021). Do more for more: Reward processing underlying apathy following moderate-to-severe traumatic brain injury. <i>The 6th Pacific Rim Conference</i> . Melbourne – Australia (virtual).
Talks at National conferences	
2022	Quang, H. et al. (2022). Motivational disorders after traumatic brain injury: Is apathy driven by abnormal sensitivity to foreground and background reward? <i>Australasian Society for the Study of Brain Impairment Conference</i> . Perth – Australia (virtual).
2021	Lee, C., Quang, H. et al. (2021). White matter changes underlying frontotemporal lobar degeneration pathology. <i>Brain and Mind Symposium</i> . Sydney – Australia.
2021	Quang, H. et al. (2021). Beyond language impairment: Profiles of apathy in primary progressive aphasia. <i>Forefront Annual Meeting 2021</i> . Sydney – Australia.
2021	Quang, H. et al. (2021). Characteristics of apathy and depression between Australians and Vietnamese: A cross-cultural study. <i>Australasian Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Conference</i> . Melbourne – Australia (virtual).
2020	Quang, H. et al. (2020). Cultural considerations in assessing motivational deficits - insights from the Vietnamese validation of apathy questionnaires. <i>Sydney Vietnam Symposium</i> . Sydney – Australia.
2019	Quang, H. et al. (2019). Clinical profiles and neural correlates of apathy in primary progressive aphasia. <i>Frontier Lab Meeting</i> . Sydney – Australia.
Posters	
2024	Piguet, O., Chuang, T., Matis, S. Quang, H. et al. (2024). Grey and White Matter Correlates of Motor Speech Disturbances in Nonfluent Progressive Aphasia Syndromes. <i>52nd INS NYC Annual North American Meeting</i> , New York, United States

2023	My-Ngan, N., ... Quang, H. (2023). No Existence or Under-recognition? Empirical Evidence for the Prevalence and Impact of Neuropsychiatric Symptoms after TBI in Vietnam. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . Taiwan.
2022	Landin-Romero, R., Lee, C., Quang, H. et al. (2022). Trajectories of brain changes predicting distinct pathology subtypes in frontotemporal dementia. <i>International Society of Frontotemporal Dementia Biennial Congress</i> . Paris – Lille, France.
2022	Quang, H. et al. (2022). Apathy, empathy and depression in behavioural frontotemporal dementia and Alzheimer's disease: Are we talking about the same thing? <i>Forefront Annual Meeting 2022</i> . Sydney – Australia.
2022	Landin-Romero, R., Quang, H. et al. (2022). Trajectories of white matter degeneration in frontotemporal dementia: new insights using fixel-based analysis. <i>Forefront Annual Meeting 2022</i> . Sydney – Australia.
2021	Quang, H. et al. (2021). Unfolding cultural variances of apathy and depression: A comparison between the Vietnamese and Australians. <i>The 6th Pacific Rim Conference</i> . Melbourne – Australia.
2021	Quang, H. et al. (2021). Influence of Family Functioning, Overprotectiveness and Self-Efficacy in Apathy after Traumatic Brain Injury. <i>International Neuropsychological Society Conference</i> . San Diego – USA.
2019	Quang, H. et al. (2019). Uncovering emotional apathy in primary progressive aphasia: A clinical and neuroimaging study. <i>Australasian Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience Conference</i> . Newcastle – Australia.

Supervision and teaching experience

Supervisor – University of New South Wales and University of Sydney – Jan 2020 - now

- Supervise and mentor Honours (in neuropsychology and speech pathology) and Master of Medicine research projects. All my students successfully completed their theses on time and with First Class Honours. Most of their research findings have been published or are currently in preparation for submission to peer-reviewed journals.

Manager –University of Sydney – Jan 2020 - now

- Oversee research activity of the Neuroimaging lab at FRONTIER – the frontotemporal dementia research clinic at University of Sydney. I provide support and training to a group of 8 students, research assistants and supporting staff.

Visiting lecturer – Hoa Sen University, Vietnam – April 2022 – now

- Taught courses in *biological psychology*, *neuroscience* and *neuropsychology*.
- Developed and implemented course materials, including syllabi, assignments, and assessments.
- Worked with colleagues to develop interdisciplinary courses and initiatives.
- Advised and mentored students on academic and career-related matters.

Visiting lecturer – Ho Chi Minh City University of Technology

- Taught courses in *developmental psychology*, with a focus on neurobiological basis of human behaviour and development.
- Developed and implemented course materials, including syllabi, assignments, and assessments.

Service and Community Engagement

Service

- Scientific Committee, **International Neuropsychology Society Conference**, Taiwan, 2023
- Member of Research Committee, **Asian Neuropsychology Association**, International Neuropsychological Society, 2022 - now.
- Student Representative, **Vietnam Neuropsychology Network**, 2022 - now.
- Student Representative, **Australasian Society for the Study of Brain Impairment**, 2019.
- President, **Student Psychological Society, Ho Chi Minh City University of Education**, 2013.

Community Engagement

- Founder - **A Brainy Chat** - a non-profit organisation that aims to disseminate psychology and neuroscience knowledge to the Vietnamese public in an engaging and interactive way, 2022 – now.
- Invited speaker - **Open talk - Neuroscience for children**, Vietnam, 2020.
- Organiser - **Trivial Night** to promote activities of Australasian Society for the Study of Brain Impairment, University of New South Wales, 2019.
- Volunteer - **Australasian Society for the Study of Brain Impairment Conference**, Wellington, New Zealand, 2019.
- Member - Australasian Society for the Study of Brain Impairment, Australasian Society for Social and Affective Neuroscience and International Neuropsychological Society.